

MDIA5004-Media Relations (T2 2025)

Assessment 1

Student Name: Ning Shen

Student Number: z5549596

Class Number: 7713

Section: T13A

Tutor Name: Ms G Jackson

Accurate words:

Part 1: Email Pitch-193

Part 2: Media Release-390

Part 3: Rationale-560

To: nareldajacobs@gmail.com

Subject: Teens anonymously call out biased media online

Hi Mrs Jacobs!

I understand that you are Australia's first openly gay indigenous female news anchor and a long-time advocate for LGBTQIA+ issues, your voice inspires us. And based on our shared values, I'd love to introduce our initiative.

A recent survey found 73% of LGBTQIA+ and culturally diverse teens feel misrepresented by news media — our campaign offers a timely response.

A new youth-led campaign, called “unmute the Truth” will be hold from 1st July to 31st August, and this campaign is aiming to give teens from 13~25 a voice against harmful media stereotypes. Launched this 2 months, our website encourages young LGBTQIA Australians to anonymously share news stories they feel misrepresent them and explain why.

The project empowers teens to push back against bias, stereotype and build media awareness in their communities. Also, this initiative helps the media and public better understand LGBTQ+ experiences and promotes fairer, more balanced coverage.

Please keep in touch and find a media release with detailed background is pasted below this pitch for reference.

Kind regards,

Ning Shen

My E-mail: 1695724329@gmail.com

Office Number: 041-286-056

28 June 2025

MEDIA RELEASE

**MINUS18 LAUNCHES CAMPAIGN TO GIVE A PLATFORM TO
ENCOURAGE TO SPEAK OUT THE MEDIA MISREPRESENTATION OF
DIVERSE TEENS**

On August 29 2025 a special day dedicated called Wear It Purple Day, which aim to empowering LGBTQIA+ youth to express themselves safely and feel respected across the country. So in line with this, our website Minus18 has launched a new campaign called “Unmute the Truth,” running from July 1st to August 31st.

Based on the statistic that 73% of LGBTQIA+ and culturally diverse teens aged 13 to 25 feel misrepresented by news media. This campaign supported by Minus18 will provide a powerful platform, it allows these young people to speak out anonymously and share their experiences and perspectives on bias from media.

Young LGBTQ people are encouraged to join the online forum via a link to Minus18. They can uploading articles they find stereotypical, offensive or harmful, explain how those portrayals affect them, and if they are willing to, they can also give some comments, suggestions and improvements to the journalist or editors. Both LGBTQIA and non-LGBTQIA participants are welcome to take part in, and they can share their feedback anonymously or under their real names. At the end of this campaign and after August 31, we will invite some experienced editors, journalists and university academics will review the submissions and respond with professional insights and advice aimed at fostering better media environment.

“We launched ‘Unmute the Truth’ because too many young people feel ignored or misrepresented in the media,” said Norman Swan, a well-known ABC reporter who is passionate about LGBTQ issues. “This campaign lets them break down harmful stereotypes and share their real stories. Every voice have to be heard. We’re listening. It’s not just about calling out the media — it’s about giving young people the power to help create fairer, more inclusive stories that truly reflect their lives.”

Minus18 is Australia’s leading organization for LGBTQIA+ youth, dedicated to creating safe, inclusive, and empowering spaces through education, youth-led events, and digital resources. As a nationally recognized non-profit, Minus18 supports thousands of young people each year, helping them feel supported and respected. Through school workshops, campaigns, and partnerships, the organisation works and aims to challenge discrimination and build friendly communities. Minus18 plays a critical role in shaping a safer, more equitable future for LGBTQIA+ youth across the country.

For more information about the conference, or register, contact Ning Shen at 041-286-056, 041-259-9296, or by email at 1695724329@gmail.com.

###

For the media release and E-mail pitch, firstly, I did the environmental scanning of Minus18. As for the external environment: Minus18 operates within a broader sociopolitical context marked by increasing public awareness and legislative support for LGBTQIA+ rights in Australia. Changes like marriage equality and more media visibility have helped create a more supportive space for advocacy. As a youth-led non-profit, Minus18 is an important part of Australia's LGBTQIA+ advocacy scene. Its programs fill in the blanks of the education and representation that some bigger institutions might miss. Its operations are driven by a commitment to youth empowerment, creating a safe and affirming space that centres young LGBTQIA+ voices and experiences.

I chose the media release subject for two main reasons. Theoretically, Mahoney (2017) emphasizes that effective PR writing must understand the audience, message purpose, and communication channels to align with strategic goals. Additionally, Richard M (2022) highlights that media framing of LGBTQIA+ youth as “vulnerable” rather than “brave” shapes public attitudes, which our campaign challenges by promoting fair and diverse representation. Personally, from my experience within the LGBTQ community, people are more sensitive to language and aware of harmful stereotypes in media. This makes it crucial not only to examine how media portrays LGBTQ individuals but also to listen to how they perceive these portrayals. Two-way communication and audience feedback are essential for meaningful media work. Lastly, my research found no existing campaigns like this, so I believe our initiative fills an important gap, making the topic timely, relevant, and newsworthy.

I selected “Unmute the Truth” as the subject of the media release because of its timeliness and social relevance, both of which are key indicators of newsworthiness. Timeliness is evident as the campaign runs from July 1 to August 31 and coincides with Wear It Purple Day on August 29, a nationally recognised event promoting LGBTQIA+ youth safety. Relevance and impact were confirmed through environmental scanning, despite generally positive coverage of Minus18, few stories center young people’s voices or their dissatisfaction with how media portrays them. This gap strengthens the campaign’s ability to generate interest and fill a media blind spot.

I chose to pitch to Narelda Jacobs, one of Australia’s first openly gay Indigenous news anchors, known for covering LGBTQIA+ issues and Sydney Mardi Gras. Because according power model in Seven Models of Framing (Hallahan 1999), When writing a media release, it is important to identify journalists who are willing to challenge or move beyond traditional power structures. My chosen journalist, Narelda Jacobs, and her articles exemplify this approach, her report aligns with Minus18’s youth empowerment goals, making her likely receptive to the campaign. Targeting a platform with authentic representation experience enhances the chance of meaningful coverage and follows strategic media engagement best practices.

According to Eggensperger and Newsom before writing, it is essential to clarify the target audience, objective, communication channel, and desired action. Emphasis should be placed on using the communication goal to guide and shape the content, rather than simply conveying facts. And I used the inverted pyramid structure from

Week 2 to present the most newsworthy info first, aiding busy journalists. The lead covers the 5Ws concisely, followed by background and two quotes to add a human touch. My boilerplate reflects Minus18's official language for brand consistency. This clear, professional format meets media release standards and boosts the likelihood of media coverage.

Reference:

Eggensperger, J. and Salvatore, J., 2022. Strategic public relations writing: *Proven tactics and techniques*. Routledge.

Hallahan, K., 1999. Seven models of framing: Implications for public relations. *Journal of public relations research*, 11(3), pp.205-242.

Mahoney, J., 2025. *Public relations writing*. Taylor & Francis, pp. 13-16.

Perloff, R.M., 2022. The fifty-year legacy of agenda-setting: Storied past, complex conundrums, future possibilities. *Mass Communication and Society*, 25(4), pp.469-499.